

ECON 454 — Group Project Working Session Agenda

Thursday, 14 May 14 2026 | ZSB – Maker Lab

Purpose of tomorrow's class: We will convert last week's technical progress into concrete capstone direction: first by reviewing the Lab with Mr. Sven, then by tightening the group project toward a genuine final software MVP, and finally by outlining each student's personalized podcast script for the professional portfolio website.

Class Outcomes — What We Need to Accomplish

1. Lab Debrief The class walks through what was built, tested, learned, or clarified during last week's Lab with Mr. Sven.	2. MVP Progress The team makes visible, defensible progress toward the final Maxess software prototype—not just ideas, but buildable decisions.	3. Portfolio Podcast Planning Each student develops a working outline for a personalized website podcast script that explains their professional identity and capstone contribution.
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Working Agenda for Class

Segment	Focus	What We Will Do	Required Progress
Opening	Orientation	Set the purpose of the day and confirm how the three parts of class connect.	Shared understanding of the target: lab learning → MVP direction → professional portfolio narrative.
Part I	Lab with Mr. Sven: Walkthrough & Debrief	Students walk me through last week's lab work. We identify what was set up, what succeeded, what remains unclear, and what should now feed the group project.	A concise team-level technical status report and a clearer link between lab experimentation and the capstone build.
Part II	Group Project: Move Toward the Final Software MVP	We refine the business concept and make explicit progress toward a genuine prototype that can be built in Lab. This includes narrowing scope, confirming the core user/value proposition, and identifying the product surfaces or logic that matter most.	A stronger MVP direction for Maxess, with concrete decisions that improve buildability, explainability, and professional value.
Part III	Personalized Podcast Script Outlines for Portfolio Websites	We outline each student's professional podcast script: who they are, what role they are taking, what they are contributing, what problem the project solves, and why the work matters.	Each student leaves with a usable script structure that can become a polished website-ready audio/video narrative.

Part II Emphasis — Business Concept to Genuine Software MVP

Questions we need to answer together

- What is the final user-facing and operator-facing story of the product?
- Which MVP features are truly necessary for a convincing final prototype?
- What data, scoring logic, dashboard surface, or recommendation layer must be visible?
- What should be built next in Lab rather than merely discussed?
- What must be deferred so the final product remains coherent?

Progress standard for tomorrow

- We should leave class with sharper scope, not wider scope.
- The group should be closer to a build plan for the final software MVP.
- The prototype direction should remain business-facing, analytics-grounded, and employer-explainable.
- Each role should become more concrete: what will be built, documented, tested, or presented?

Part III Emphasis — Personalized Podcast Script Outlines

Working script structure

- Professional introduction: who I am and what I am building toward.
- Project framing: what Maxess is and what business problem it addresses.
- My role: what I personally own, contribute, or translate for the team.
- Evidence of value: what artifact, feature, decision, or system contribution demonstrates my work.
- Closing relevance: why this project matters for my professional future.

What students should leave with

- A personalized script outline aligned to their actual project role.
- A sharper connection between the group capstone and their individual portfolio website.
- A clear story that can become website audio/video, a narrated project intro, or a polished professional statement.
- A stronger ability to explain not only what was built, but why it matters.

What to Bring / Be Ready to Discuss

Bring	Be Ready to Explain	Leave With
Any relevant notes, screenshots, files, or recollections from last week's Lab with Mr. Sven.	What your group now believes the final software MVP should actually become.	A more concrete shared build path for the capstone project.
Your current understanding of your capstone role and likely portfolio evidence.	What must be built next—and what should be cut, simplified, or delayed.	A first-pass outline for your personalized portfolio podcast script.
Questions that need clarity before Lab work proceeds further.	How your individual work contributes to the professional story of the final product.	Clearer preparation for upcoming website completion and the final capstone

Bottom line: Tomorrow is a project-acceleration session. We are using the lab foundation, the capstone business concept, and the portfolio website work to push toward a final project that is coherent, demonstrable, and professionally useful.